

The Good Samaritan: Who Is My Neighbor?

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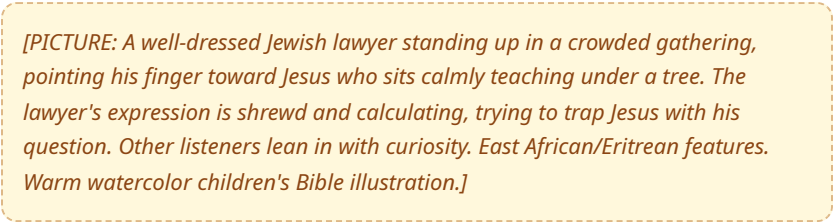
Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 67 of 80

Scene 1 of 25



A lawyer stands up to test Jesus. This is not an attorney as we know today — he is an expert in the Torah, the Law of Moses. He is educated, respected, and confident in his own righteousness. He approaches Jesus not with genuine curiosity but with a trap disguised as a question: "Teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?" Notice the arrogance embedded in the question — "what must I do?" He assumes eternal life is something he can earn through his own effort, his own performance, his own religious achievement. He does not come hungry for truth; he comes to display his knowledge and expose what he assumes are flaws in Jesus's teaching. This is a public challenge, a theological debate in front of witnesses. But Jesus, as always, sees through the performance to the heart beneath. The lawyer wants to justify himself. Jesus wants to transform him. This tension between self-justification and genuine transformation is the engine that drives the entire parable that follows.

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Hade Tebeqa niYesus kifiTino tensi'u. Izi kenti lomi nifeliho Tebeqa aykonen — ab Tora nay Higi Muse ki'ila iyu. Mihur, ziKhber, binay geza'e ri'isu ts'idqi zite'amammen iyu. NiYesus biHaqena hintuynet zeykone bimelki'e HiTo ziteHab'e mefeNTera qeribu: "Memhir, nay zel'alem hiyewet kiwers intay kigeber aleni?"

Scene 2 of 25

[PICTURE: Jesus sitting peacefully with a gentle smile, his hand raised in a teaching gesture, turning the question back to the lawyer. The lawyer looks slightly surprised, not expecting Jesus to redirect the conversation. A Torah scroll is visible in the background. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jesus does not answer directly. Instead, with the wisdom that confounds the wise, He turns the question back: "What is written in the Law? How do you read it?" This is brilliant on multiple levels. First, Jesus acknowledges the man's expertise — you're the legal scholar, you tell me. Second, He refuses to be trapped into a theological debate on the lawyer's terms. Third, He reveals something profound: the answer to the greatest question of human existence — how to have eternal life — is not hidden or complicated. It is written plainly in the very Scripture this man studies every day. The problem is never that God's commands are unclear. The problem is that we look for loopholes rather than obedience. Jesus is essentially saying, "You already know the answer. The question is whether you're willing to live it." This pattern appears throughout Jesus's ministry — He rarely gives people new information. Instead, He confronts them with truth they already possess but refuse to apply.

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*Yesus biqeTta ayimilsin. Ab kindu niTibebenyatat zidenigir biTibeb neta HiTo yimilsa:
"Ab Higi intay ts'eHifu alo? BiKemey tinibbo?" Izi bibizuH dereja biluts' iyu. Qedamay
Yesus niki'ilet iti seb yi'imenno — niska nay Higi mihur iKa niska nigereni. Kal'ay
biqalat iti Tebeqa ab ziqewm nay sine-melekot kit'e kiteHaz yi'abi.*

Scene 3 of 25

[PICTURE: The lawyer reciting confidently with one hand raised, quoting Scripture from memory. His face shows pride in his correct answer. Jesus nods approvingly but with knowing eyes that see deeper. Other listeners murmur in agreement. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The lawyer answers correctly — perfectly, in fact. He quotes the Shema from Deuteronomy 6:5 and combines it with Leviticus 19:18: "Love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your strength, and with all your mind; and love your neighbor as yourself." Jesus affirms him: "You have answered correctly. Do this and you will live." The answer is elegant in its simplicity: love God completely, love people fully. Every commandment, every law, every prophetic word ultimately comes down to these two movements of the heart. But notice — Jesus says "DO this." Not "know this," not "recite this," not "believe this intellectually." DO it. Live it. The gap between knowing and doing is where most of us live our entire spiritual lives. This lawyer can quote the perfect answer, but as the next question reveals, he has spent his career finding ways to limit love rather than expand it. Head knowledge without heart obedience is worthless in the kingdom of God.

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*Iti Tebeqa biqinu'e yimlis — biHaqi bifits'um. Kab Zedagim 6:5 Shema yiTeqis mis
Lewawyan 19:18 Hawisu: "Ni'Igzi'abher AmlaKhKa bikulu libKa bikulu nefSka bikulu
HayliKa bikulu a'imroKa afqiro; nibits'ayKa dima kem nefSka afqiro." Yesus
yeregagiTs'elu: "Qinu'e melisKa. Izi gibero kitinebir iKa."*

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*Ginake nigeza'e ri'isu keets'diq deliyu niYesus "bits'ayey di'a men iyu?" ilu Hatete.
Luqas neti mikinyat binitsur yinigerena — nigeza'e ri'isu keets'diq yideli. Niti'izaz
kiqwets'ats'ero kiKh'il ziKh'ilo kidirito ab zurya'u ankel kiHints'ts' yideli.*

Scene 5 of 25

[PICTURE: Jesus beginning to tell the parable, his hands gesturing as if painting a picture in the air. The scene transitions to show a lone traveler on a winding mountain road descending from Jerusalem. The road is rocky and desolate, with shadows in the cliffs. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jesus begins the parable: "A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho." With these simple words, Jesus paints a scene every listener would immediately recognize. The road from Jerusalem to Jericho was one of the most dangerous stretches in all of Judea — a steep descent of over 3,000 feet in just 17 miles, winding through barren wilderness and rocky ravines. It was nicknamed "the Way of Blood" because of the frequent robberies and murders that occurred there. Jesus does not identify the traveler's ethnicity, his religion, or his social status. He is simply "a man" — a human being, made in God's image. This is deliberate. Jesus strips away every label that might make the listener decide whether this person deserves compassion. He is not a Jew, a Gentile, a rich man, or a poor man in the story. He is a person. He is vulnerable. He is about to suffer. And that is all that should matter when we encounter someone in need.

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*Yesus neti misale yijimir: "Hade seb kab Iyerusalem nab Iyariko yiwerid nebere."
Bezen qelelti qalat Yesus kulu sema'i biqits'bet zifeliTo awdi yiHints'ts'. Kab
Iyerusalem nab Iyariko ziKeyd mengedi ab kulu Yihuda kab ziHayele Hadegena
botatat Hade nebere.*

Scene 6 of 25

[PICTURE: A panoramic view of the ancient road from Jerusalem to Jericho - steep, winding, descending through barren desert hills with deep ravines on either side. Hidden caves dot the cliff faces where bandits would hide. The road is narrow and isolated with no help in sight. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The Jericho road was not just dangerous — it was notorious. It descended from Jerusalem at 2,500 feet above sea level to Jericho at 800 feet below sea level, making it one of the steepest major roads in the ancient world. The terrain was perfect for ambush — limestone caves provided hiding places, sharp turns blocked line of sight, and the desolate wilderness meant no witnesses and no help nearby. Travelers were advised never to walk this road alone, yet many had no choice. The road represents something deeper in Jesus's story: it is the reality of a broken world. People get hurt. Violence happens. Suffering is real and often random. The question Jesus is really asking through this parable is not "why do bad things happen?" but "what do you do when you encounter someone who has been broken by this world?" The road to Jericho exists in every city, every school, every community. Someone near you right now is lying wounded on their own Jericho road.

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“你這是在說笑嗎？”他問，“你這是在說笑嗎？”

Nay Iyariko mendedi Hadegena Tiray ayneberen — zitefelihe nebere. Kab Iyerusalem ab li'ili ts'ifhi baHri 2,500 igri nab Iyariko ab tiHti ts'ifhi baHri 800 igri yiwerid, ab Tintawi alem kab ziqulqulu abeiti mendedetat Hade zigebro. Iti bota nimeTiqa'iti fits'um nebere.

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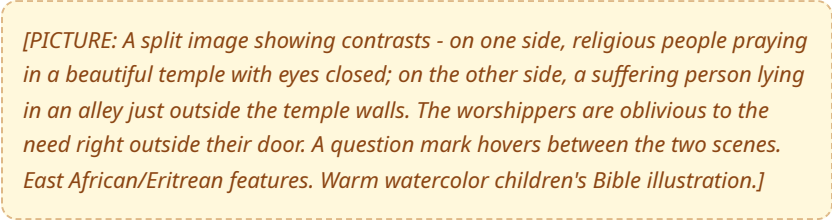
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biruhun milu'in iyu. Gefefiwo — aqHutu Tiray zeykone kibru ba'ilu wesidomi. Ab
Tintawi alem libsi mennet, maHberawi dereja, alet yiHbir nebere. Bizey libsi izi seb
zeylele iyu.*

Bi'agatami Hade Kahin bita mengedi yiwerid nebere, mis re'ayo dima biKal'e wegen Halifu kede. Kahin — milu'e hiyewetu ni'Amlakhin nihizbuninab migilgal zitewefye seb. NiHaTi'at meswa'iti zeqrib, Higi zimihir, ab mengo Amlakhin hizbin kem ma'ikelay ziqewm seb. Hade kiqewm zigib'o inteHaliyu nisu iyu.

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*Kem'u dima Hade Lewawi nabti bota mis mets'e qeribu re'aye biKal'e wegen dima
Halifu kede. Lewawi nay bete meqides reda'i iyu — kab Kahin ziteHate ma'irig ginake
gena haymanotawi moyawi. Wesani neger astebhil: Lewawi "qeribu re'aye." BiriHqet
Tiray zire'aye Kahin zeykone Lewawi biHaqi yiqerib. Yimeramir.*

Scene 11 of 25



Why do religious people often fail to show mercy? This is not just a first-century problem — it is a pattern that repeats throughout history and continues today. Religion can actually become an obstacle to compassion when it prioritizes rules over relationships, purity over people, orthodoxy over orthopraxy. The priest and Levite were not evil men. They were professionals who had convinced themselves that serving God in the Temple was more important than serving God's image-bearers on the road. They had created a hierarchy of holiness where institutional service ranked above human compassion. This is the danger of religious professionalism — when your job is "being holy," you can convince yourself that maintaining your religious status IS the loving thing to do. "I cannot help this one person because I serve thousands in the Temple." But God never accepts institutional duty as an excuse for personal cruelty. The prophets thundered this message: "I desire mercy, not sacrifice." Religion without compassion is not merely incomplete — it is offensive to God.

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[illegible]

Haymanotawi sebat himintay bizuH gize riHraHe mir'ay yifeshlu? Izi nay qedamay kifle zemen ts'egem Tiray aykonen — ab tariKh zidegagimn lomi'wun ziqits'ilin agebab iyu. Haymanot nidenibitatat kab zimidinatatat, nits'iHna kab sebat, ortodoksi kab qinu'e gibri mis qedeme ants'ar riHraHe inqifaz kiKewn yiKh'il iyu.

Scene 12 of 25

[PICTURE: A Samaritan man on a donkey appearing on the road, the listeners' faces in the foreground showing shock, disgust, and surprise at Jesus making a Samaritan the hero. The Samaritan himself looks ordinary and kind, riding toward the wounded man. A dramatic contrast between the audience's prejudice and the man's simple humanity. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"But a Samaritan, as he traveled, came where the man was." Three words that would have shocked Jesus's audience to their core: "But a Samaritan." To understand the radical nature of this story, you must understand that for Jesus's Jewish audience, making a Samaritan the hero was like making your worst enemy the saint of the story. It would be like telling a story today where the person you despise most — based on ethnicity, nationality, religion, or political affiliation — turns out to be the only one who shows God's love. Jesus deliberately chose the most offensive hero possible. He could have made the hero a Jewish layman — that would have been a mild critique of religious leaders. He could have made the hero a Roman — that would have been surprising but theologically neutral. Instead, He chose a Samaritan — the one group Jews actively hated, whose very existence they considered an insult to God. Jesus didn't just challenge the lawyer's question. He detonated it.

[illegible]

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*Ginake Hade Samaryawi kiGo'az kelo nabti zelo mets'e. NiSema'iti Yesus kis'a'e
 wishiTom zisinbid seleste qalat: "Ginake Hade Samaryawi." Nayzi zanta Hayal bahri
 nimird'a ni'Ayhudawiyen sema'iti Yesus Samaryawi jigna migbar kemti ziKhfi'e
 ts'ela'iKa nay zanta qidus migbar malet minbaru kitirdi'o aleKa.*

Scene 13 of 25

[PICTURE: A historical visualization showing the divide between Jews and Samaritans - two groups on opposite hills with a deep valley between them. On one hill, the Jerusalem Temple; on the other, Mount Gerizim with the Samaritan temple. People on both sides turn their backs to each other with expressions of contempt and hatred. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

To understand why "a Samaritan" was so shocking, you need the history. After Solomon's kingdom split around 930 BC, the northern kingdom of Israel eventually mixed with Assyrian settlers after their conquest in 722 BC. The resulting population — Samaritans — were viewed by Jews as racial and religious traitors. They had intermarried with pagans. They worshipped God on Mount Gerizim instead of Jerusalem. They accepted only the first five books of Moses. Jews and Samaritans had hated each other for over 700 years by Jesus's time. Jews would travel days out of their way to avoid crossing Samaritan territory. They considered Samaritan food unclean and Samaritan testimony invalid in court. A common Jewish prayer included thanking God for not making them a Samaritan. This hatred was not casual prejudice — it was deep, generational, religious, cultural, and personal. When Jesus made a Samaritan the hero, He was taking the most hated "other" in His audience's world and saying: "This person you despise? He understands God's heart better than your priests."

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*Samaryawi nimintay kemzi zisinbid kem zinebere nimird'a tariKh tideli. Mengisti
 Selomon ab 930 q.l.k. mis tefelaleye semienawi mengisti Israel ab 722 q.l.k. mis
 tesa'ire mis Asorawiyen seferti teHawawese. Itom ziwets'u hizbi — Samaryawiyen —
 bi'Ayhud kem aletawin haymanotawin Telamat yiri'eyu neberu.*

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*Mis re'ayo dima biriHraHe teneqaneqe. Abzi ziteTeqme nay GriKh qal
"esplanchnisthe" iyu — biqeTta anjet terebshe malet. Izi li'ul zeykone simi'it wey riHuq
rihrahe aykonen. Akalawi koynu ni'akal zits'eliwo nay wishiT i ziHinziz riHraHe iyu.*

Scene 15 of 25

[PICTURE: The Samaritan kneeling beside the wounded man, lifting his head gently, offering water from a flask. The man is clearly Jewish based on subtle details, and the Samaritan knows this but helps anyway. The Samaritan crosses the invisible boundary of hatred - shown as a fading wall of prejudice dissolving between them. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

He goes TO the wounded man — crossing every boundary. Consider what this Samaritan risked. The man might be Jewish — someone raised to despise Samaritans. If he recovers, he might not even thank his rescuer. He might be disgusted to learn a Samaritan touched him. The Samaritan's own community might condemn him for helping an enemy. The robbers might still be nearby, making him the next victim. The act of helping could make him ceremonially unclean in his own religious tradition. He could be accused of being the attacker if someone comes along and sees a Samaritan with a wounded Jew. Every calculation says "walk away." Every self-protective instinct says "this is not your problem." But compassion overrides calculation. Love silences fear. The Samaritan does not cross to the other side — he crosses TO the man. This is the movement of grace: not away from need, but toward it. Not protecting yourself from contamination by suffering, but entering into it. God Himself modeled this when He crossed the infinite boundary between heaven and earth to reach wounded humanity.

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[illegible]

Nabti qusul seb yiKeyd — kulu deret segiru. Izi Samaryawi intay kem ziHagagese Hiseb. Iti seb Ayhudawi kiKewn yiKh'il — niSamaryawiyān niminaq zi'abeye seb. Mis ziHawi ni'adiHani'u misgana'wun ayhib yiKewn. Samaryawi tinkifiwo mis zifeliT kits'ela'e yiKh'il.

Scene 16 of 25

[PICTURE: The Samaritan carefully bandaging the wounded man's injuries, pouring oil and wine from small flasks onto the wounds. His hands are gentle and skilled. The wounded man's face shows relief and gratitude through his pain. Medical supplies from the Samaritan's travel pack are spread around them on the dusty road. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

He bandages wounds, pours oil and wine — practical, costly care. The Samaritan does not just feel compassion; he acts on it with skill and sacrifice. Oil was used as a soothing agent to prevent infection and reduce pain. Wine was used as an antiseptic to clean the wounds. Bandages required tearing his own clothing or supplies. Every resource he uses on this stranger is something he needed for his own journey. This is not cheap compassion — it costs him personally. Notice the specificity of the care: he does not just throw money at the problem from a distance. He gets his hands dirty. He touches the wounds. He applies the medicine himself. True compassion is always specific, always personal, always costly. It is easy to post about caring on social media. It is easy to donate to a cause you never have to see. But getting on your knees in the dirt beside someone who is bleeding — that is a different kind of love entirely. The Samaritan models what James would later write: "Faith without works is dead."

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Qusli yi'asir, zeytin weyinin yiKh'iwo — gibirawi kibur hagez. Samaryawi riHraHe Tiray
ayisime'on, biKi'iletin meswa'itinetin yiserHalu. Zeyti kem afezazi nirekHsi
nimikiliKalin qanza niminkayin yiTeqem nebere. Weyni kem antiseptik qusli
nimits'iray yiTeqem nebere.

*Qusli yi'asir, zeytin weyinin yiKh'iwo — gibirawi kibur hagez. Samaryawi riHraHe Tiray
ayisime'on, biKi'iletin meswa'itinetin yiserHalu. Zeyti kem afezazi nirekHsi
nimikiliKalin qanza niminkayin yiTeqem nebere. Weyni kem antiseptik qusli
nimits'iray yiTeqem nebere.*

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*Ab natu geza'e adgi yesqelo — wilqawi miCHot yiswi'e. Ab Tintawi alem adgi nay
miCHot Tiray ayneberen — agedasi meGo'azya, nay quTebawi ts'in'at milikiti, bizuH
gize dima aziyu kibur Tirit seb nebere. Samaryawi niqusul seb ab adgu yesqelo malet
Samaryawi ba'ilu Hiji bi'igru kiKeyd alewo malet iyu.*

Scene 18 of 25

[PICTURE: The Samaritan arriving at a roadside inn at dusk, helping the wounded man down from the donkey at the entrance. The innkeeper stands in the doorway with a lamp, looking at the unusual pair. The inn is a simple stone building with warm light coming from inside, representing safety and shelter after the dangerous road. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

He takes him to an inn — providing shelter and safety. The Samaritan does not simply patch the man up and leave him by the roadside to figure things out alone. He carries the commitment further. He brings him to a place of rest, of recovery, of ongoing care. An inn in the ancient world was not a luxury hotel — it was a basic shelter where travelers could sleep safely, eat, and recover from the rigors of the road. But for a wounded man, it was everything — walls between him and further danger, a roof over his head, a bed instead of hard ground, and the presence of other people who could help if his condition worsened. The Samaritan understands something crucial: first aid is not enough. This man needs sustained care. He needs time to heal. He needs a safe environment for recovery. True compassion thinks beyond the immediate crisis to the long-term recovery. It does not just stop the bleeding — it ensures healing. Too often we offer crisis intervention without follow-through, a meal without relationship, a prayer without presence.

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Nab meHderi yebits'Ho — iquban diHnetin yihib. Samaryawi neti seb aHiwyu ab Tiqa mangedi gedifu nibeynu kifeliT aygedifon. Qal kidan niqidmit yiwesido. Nab nay irefiti, nay miHway, nay qets'ali hagez bota yebits'Ho. Ab Tintawi alem meHderi nay kibri hotel ayneberen.

Scene 19 of 25

[PICTURE: Inside the inn the next morning, the Samaritan placing two silver coins (denarii) in the innkeeper's palm. The innkeeper nods in understanding. Behind them, the wounded man rests peacefully on a bed. The Samaritan's travel bag is packed, ready to continue his journey, but his eyes still show concern for the recovering man. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

He pays for his care — an open-ended financial commitment. The next day, the Samaritan gives the innkeeper two denarii. A denarius was a full day's wages for a laborer — so this was two days' pay. Enough to cover approximately two weeks of room and board at an ancient inn. But this is not merely a transaction; it represents something deeper. The Samaritan puts his own money — earned through his own labor — toward the recovery of a complete stranger. He does not know this man's name, his story, or whether he will ever be repaid. He does not set conditions: "I'll pay if he's grateful" or "I'll pay if he's a good person." He simply pays because the man needs care and has no resources of his own. This challenges our transactional approach to compassion. We want to know if people "deserve" our help. We want guarantees of gratitude. We calculate return on investment even in our generosity. The Samaritan gives freely because the need is the only qualification required.

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*NiHagezu yiKefil — kifut zikone nay genzeb qal kidan. Nits'baHitu Samaryawi
niHalawi meHderi kilte dinar yihbo. Hade dinar niHade ilet siraH ziKewn milu'e
demoz seraHtenya nebere — slezi nay kilte me'alti demoz. Ab Tintawi meHderi
ni'astat kilte semun kifillin migbin zishifin zi'akil.*

Scene 20 of 25

[PICTURE: The Samaritan at the door of the inn, speaking earnestly to the innkeeper, pointing back toward the room where the wounded man rests. He holds up his hand as if making a promise to return. The innkeeper holds the coins and nods. The Samaritan's donkey waits outside, ready for departure. A sense of ongoing commitment fills the scene. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Take care of him; whatever more you spend, when I return I will reimburse you." This final instruction reveals the fullest extent of the Samaritan's commitment. He does not cap his generosity. He does not say "two denarii is all I can give." He writes a blank check: whatever this man needs, provide it, and I will cover the cost. This is extravagant, reckless, almost foolish generosity. The innkeeper could take advantage of him. The bill could be enormous. The man might never recover. None of these possibilities stop the Samaritan from making an unlimited commitment to a stranger's healing. This is how God loves — without limits, without conditions, without a cap on His grace. "While we were still sinners, Christ died for us." God did not calculate the cost and decide we were not worth it. He paid whatever was required — even His own Son's life — and promised to continue providing for our healing until we are fully restored. The Samaritan's blank check mirrors the infinite grace of God.

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*TeKenaKeno, kabzi nila'ili ziwets'i kulu mis temelsku kiKefileKa iye. Izi nay meweda'eta
memriHi milu'e sifHat nay Samaryawi qal kidan yigelits'. Legasinetu aydiirton. "Kilte
dinar kihib ziKh'ilo kulu iyu" aybilin. Kifut chek yits'Hif: izi seb zidelyo zikone habwo
neti wets'a'i kishifino iye.*

Yesus neta HiTo bizsinbid liki'inet yimilsa: "Kab selesti'om ab id kelesti ziwdedeq seb bits'ay ziKono men yimisileKa?" Nay Yesus aqawma biliHi astebhil. Tebeqa "bits'ayey men iyu?" Hatete — malet "fiqrey zigib'o men iyu?" Yesus nab "bits'ay zikone men nebere?" yiqiyiro — malet "fiqri zir'aye men?"

Scene 22 of 25

[PICTURE: The lawyer looking down, unable to meet Jesus's eyes, reluctantly answering the question. He cannot bring himself to say the word "Samaritan" - his prejudice is visible even in his surrender to the truth. Other listeners watch with dawning understanding. Some look convicted, others amazed. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The lawyer answers: "The one who showed mercy to him." Notice — he cannot bring himself to say the word "Samaritan." His prejudice runs so deep that even when forced to acknowledge a Samaritan's righteousness, he uses a euphemism: "the one who showed mercy." He knows the answer. The truth has cornered him. The hated outsider was the only one who fulfilled God's command to love. The religious insiders — priest and Levite — failed completely. The story has exposed the lawyer's question for what it truly was: an attempt to justify his own selective compassion. He wanted permission to withhold love from Samaritans, from Gentiles, from "sinners." Instead, Jesus has shown that a Samaritan understood love better than the entire religious establishment. The lawyer is trapped by his own theology — he cannot deny that mercy is the highest expression of the Law he claims to follow. And he cannot deny that the Samaritan showed it while his own religious leaders did not.

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*Tebeqa yimlis: "Ni'u riHraHe zir'aye." Atebhil — "Samaryawi" zibil qal kiblo ayKh'ilin.
Adliwo'u kis'a'e kindizi zi'ameqe koynu ts'idqi Samaryawi ki'imen mis tegeded'wun
nay zeyqeTta azerarba yiTeqem: "RiHraHe zir'aye." Melsi yifeliT. Haqi denbiswo alo.*

Scene 23 of 25

[PICTURE: Jesus standing with authority, his hand extended toward the lawyer and the crowd, delivering the final command "Go and do likewise." The words seem to radiate from him like light. The lawyer and crowd look changed - some inspired, some uncomfortable, all challenged. The scene carries a sense of divine authority and urgency. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

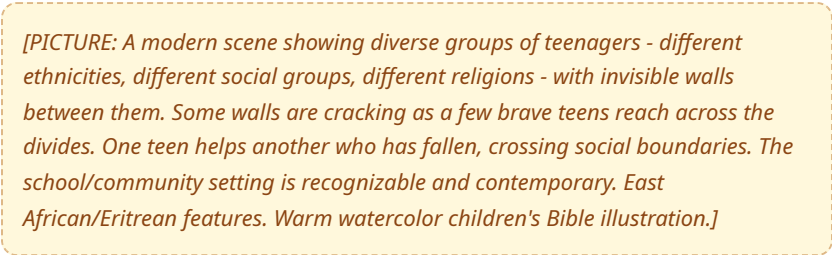
"Go and do likewise." Four words that changed history. Jesus does not say "go and think about this." He does not say "go and debate this with your colleagues." He says GO — move, act, leave this place of comfort and intellectual discussion — and DO — make it physical, make it real, make it cost you something — LIKEWISE — exactly as the Samaritan did, with the same abandon, the same boundary-crossing, the same unlimited compassion. This is a command, not a suggestion. It is not an invitation to consider being more compassionate when convenient. It is a direct order from the Son of God: go find the wounded, cross every boundary that separates you from them, and show mercy that costs you everything you have. This command stands over every generation, every culture, every church. It has not expired. It has not been softened. It has not been qualified with exceptions. Go. Do. Likewise. Show mercy to whoever lies wounded on your road, regardless of who they are, what they believe, or what they have done.

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Kid nisKa dima kem'u giber. TariKh ziqeyere arba'ite qalat. Yesus "kid biza'iba izi Hiseb" aybilin. "Kid mis mesariHitKa teKebaber" aybilin. Kid yibil — tenqesaqes giber nay miCHotin nay a'imro kit'in bota gidef — giber — akalawi gibero Haqena gibero gele neger yiKhfilKa — kem'u — liki'e kemti Samaryawi zigebero.

Scene 24 of 25



Who is the "Samaritan" in your world? Who do you avoid? Every person, every community, every culture has its "Samaritans" — the group that is despised, mocked, excluded, considered less-than. For some, it is people of a different ethnicity or tribe. For others, it is those of a different religion or political viewpoint. In schools, it might be the outcasts, the "weird" kids, the ones from the wrong neighborhood. In churches, it might be those with different theological views, different lifestyles, or different social standings. Jesus's parable forces an uncomfortable question: could the person you most despise be the one who best understands God's heart? Could the group your community labels as "other" be the one God is using to shame the religious establishment? Who are you avoiding? Whose suffering do you walk past because helping them would make you uncomfortable, would challenge your prejudices, would cost your reputation among your own tribe? That person — that group — is your Jericho road test. Your answer reveals whether you truly follow Jesus or merely admire Him from a safe distance.

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*Nayzzi misale ategbar qelilin kis'a'e zeyke'al kebidin iyu: bizey deret riHraHe ar'i alem
ziHants'ets'eto kulu smer zisegir riHraHe zirigaH. "Izi seb hagezey yigib'o'do?" ilKa
aytiHitet — ts'ega zigib'o Hade yelon ts'ega zigebro nisu iyu. "Izi seb kemay diyu?"
ilKa aytiHitet — Amlak ab li'ili ts'adiqanin amets'enyatatn bima'ire zinab yisedid.*

English: Your neighbor is anyone in need, regardless of their identity. Love is not a feeling to be reserved for those like you — it is an action to be extended to everyone, especially those your world tells you to despise. The question is never "who deserves my compassion?" but "am I willing to show it?" Go and do likewise.

[illegible]

Key Verse: "Go and do likewise." — Luke 10:37

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Discussion Questions

1. Who are the "Samaritans" in your community — the people or groups that are looked down upon, avoided, or considered "other"? Be honest about the prejudices you carry. Where did those attitudes come from, and what would it look like to challenge them?

[illegible]

2. The priest and Levite had religious reasons for passing by. What "religious excuses" do Christians today use to avoid showing compassion? How can devotion to God become an excuse for ignoring people in need?

[illegible]

3. There is a difference between convenient compassion (helping when it's easy) and costly compassion (helping when it requires sacrifice). Give examples of each from your own life. Which type does Jesus call us to in this parable?

[illegible]

4. Jesus reframes the question from "who is my neighbor?" to "who was a neighbor?" How does this change our

A Prayer for Boundless Compassion

Lord Jesus, You are the true Good Samaritan. You crossed the infinite distance between heaven and earth to reach us when we lay wounded and helpless on the road of sin. You did not pass by on the other side. You came to us, touched our wounds, bore our pain, and paid a price we could never repay. Thank You for Your mercy that knows no limits.

Forgive us for the times we have been the priest and the Levite — seeing need and crossing to the other side. Forgive us for our religious excuses, our convenient blindness, our selective compassion. Forgive us for drawing circles around our love and deciding who deserves it and who does not.

Give us eyes to see the wounded on our road. Open our hearts to feel the compassion that moves us to action, not just sympathy that leaves us comfortable. Give us the courage to cross every boundary — of prejudice, of tribalism, of comfort, of reputation — to reach those who are suffering.

Break down the walls of hatred we have built. Shatter our prejudices with Your love. Show us the image of God in every person — especially those we have been taught to despise. Help us remember that we were once the stranger lying half dead on the road, and someone crossed the distance to save us.

Make us neighbors to everyone we meet. Not because they deserve it, but because You command it. Not because it is easy, but because it is right. Not because we are good, but because You are good through us. May our compassion have no limits, our mercy no boundaries, and our love no conditions. In the name of Jesus, who showed us what true mercy looks like. Amen.

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

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